

WEEKLY TRADING PERFORMANCE REPORT

Analysis Period:	May 11-15, 2026
Report Generated:	May 15, 2026
Trader:	James
Account:	LIVE ACCOUNT (Schwab) + Shadow Paper Account
Strategies:	SPX Bull Put Spreads SPX Bear Call Spreads Iron Condors (new)
Market:	Hot CPI (3.8%) and scorching PPI (6.0% YoY). SPX hit ATH 7,514. Dow above 50,000. Trump-Xi summit. Kevin Warsh conf

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Overall Performance: Live account -\$380 across 12 trades (54.5% clean win rate). Shadow account +\$8,440 across 7 trades (100% win rate). Combined: +\$8,060. The first full week of live trading produced the most important data point of the entire journey: **thin premium trades are unprofitable**. Trades entered at $\leq \$0.45$ premium lost -\$1,205 combined (1 win, 4 losses). Trades entered at $> \$0.45$ gained +\$1,575 (5 wins, 1 loss). The system works — but only when premium is sufficient to absorb the 2x stop on gamma noise.

Key Findings:

- THIN PREMIUM IS THE #1 ISSUE: 5 trades at $\leq \$0.45$ entry produced -\$1,205. The 2x stop fires on gamma noise before expiry. Minimum credit floor of $\sim \$0.60$ for SPX identified.
- Thicker premium trades work: 6 trades at $> \$0.45$ produced +\$1,575 (83% win rate). The system's edge exists above the premium floor.
- Trade 166 ERROR: Unplanned entry from uncanceled pre-market order. Cascaded into cancelled stop and panic close. -\$750. Same error pattern as USO (Account 1, Rule 15).
- Trade 164 Rule 10 breach: Emotional reopen after CPI stop-out. Recognised and closed quickly — self-correction is improving.
- Iron condors debut on live: Trade 171 (+\$220, 55% capture). Shadow ICs 100% win rate (5/5). IC structure showing real promise.
- Fees are real now: Trade 162 cost \$91.46 in fees/commissions for \$0 P&L.; Churning from indecision is expensive on live money.

Strategic Assessment: This week exposed the precise boundary between profitable and unprofitable trade selection on the live account. The data is unambiguous: below $\sim \$0.45$ - 0.60 premium, the 2x stop is too sensitive to gamma noise on SPX 0DTE. Every stop-out this week was on a position that expired OTM — the thesis was correct, the premium was insufficient to survive the intraday path. This is the single most actionable finding since Account 3 began. A minimum credit floor of $\$0.60$ would have eliminated four of the five losses this week.

WEEKLY P&L; SUMMARY

Account	Trades	Wins	Losses	Win %	Net P&L
Live — Thick prem ($> \$0.45$)	6	5	1	83.3%	+\$1,575
Live — Thin prem ($\leq \$0.45$)	5	1	4	20%	-\$1,205
Live — Error (#166)	1	0	1	—	-\$750
Live Total	12	6	6	54.5%	-\$380
Shadow Account	7	7	0	100%	+\$8,440
COMBINED	19	13	6	68.4%	+\$8,060

The thick/thin premium split is the headline. Same system, same stops, same trader — the only variable is entry premium. Above $\$0.45$: +\$1,575. Below $\$0.45$: -\$1,205.

THE THIN PREMIUM PROBLEM

This is the most important analysis of the week. Every loss on the live account (excluding the error trade) shares one characteristic: thin entry premium that made the 2x stop hypersensitive to gamma noise.

#	Strikes	Entry	2x Stop	Result	SPX at Expiry	Would Have Won
161	7360/7340	\$0.40	\$0.80	Stopped -\$600	OTM	Yes
162	7390/7370	\$0.20	\$0.40	Churned \$0	N/A	N/A
163	7395/7415	\$0.35	\$0.70	Stopped -\$825	OTM (7366)	Yes
169	7450/7430	\$0.45	\$0.90	Stopped -\$180	OTM	Yes

Why Thin Premium Fails With 2x Stops:

When you sell a spread for \$0.35, the 2x stop fires at \$0.70 — just \$0.35 of adverse movement. On SPX 0DTE, gamma is extremely high in the final hours. A 10-15 point SPX move can cause \$0.35 of premium expansion on a near-OTM spread even when the strike is never truly threatened. The stop fires on noise, not on genuine risk. Meanwhile, a \$0.80 entry has a 2x stop at \$1.60 — \$0.80 of headroom. The same 10-15 point move barely registers.

The Fix — Minimum Credit Floor:

Based on this week's data: no SPX 0DTE credit spread should be entered below \$0.60 premium. At \$0.60, the 2x stop fires at \$1.20, giving \$0.60 of headroom — enough to survive typical gamma fluctuations without being triggered by noise. This is a candidate for the pre-trade checklist as a hard gate. Below \$0.60 = no trade, regardless of how safe the strikes look.

#	Strikes	Entry	Result	P&L	Capture
160	7345/7325	\$0.70	Expired	+\$350	100%
165	7355/7335	\$0.40*	Expired	+\$400	100%
167	7370/7350	\$0.50	Expired	+\$500	100%
168	7400/7380	\$0.675	85% close	+\$230	85%
170	7335/7315	\$0.80	62.5% close	+\$500	62.5%
171	IC 7500-7350	\$1.00	55% close	+\$220	55%

**Trade 165 at \$0.40 was the exception — placed during the CPI selloff when premium was elevated by the move, providing genuine edge. Context matters alongside the floor rule.*

LIVE ACCOUNT DAILY BREAKDOWN

MONDAY 11 MAY — -\$250 (Pre-CPI Tension)

VIX 18.95. BEARISH signal (3.0/5). Three BPS trades: one expired (+\$350), one stopped on thin premium (-\$600), one churned on indecision (\$0 but \$91 in fees). Net: learned that pre-CPI days have elevated gamma that punishes thin premium entries.

TUESDAY 12 MAY — -\$650 (CPI Day)

CPI hot: 3.8% YoY headline, 2.8% core. SPX sold to 7338 then recovered to 7366. Trade 163 was a thin-premium BCS that stopped on gamma despite the thesis being correct (SPX closed at 7366 vs 7395 strike). Trade 164 was an emotional reopen — Rule 10 breach. Recognised and closed quickly for -\$225. Trade 165 expired worthless for +\$400 — placed during the selloff recovery. Good read on the day's direction but damaged by thin premium and emotional re-entry on earlier trades.

WEDNESDAY 13 MAY — -\$250 (PPI Shock)

PPI scorching: 1.4% MoM (vs 0.5% expected), 6.0% YoY. Largest monthly PPI since March 2022. Trade 166 was the week's error — uncanceled pre-market limit filled into the PPI print. No plan existed for this trade. Stop was cancelled under pressure. Panic close on bounce. SPX recovered to ATH 7438. Position would have been full profit. Cost: -\$750 plus the lesson. Trade

167 was the recovery — entered after PPI absorbed, expired worthless for +\$500.

THURSDAY 14 MAY — +\$50 (ATH Day)

SPX hit 7,514. Dow above 50,000. Trump-Xi summit positive. Warsh confirmed as Fed Chair. Trade 168 was clean — tranche entry technique, 85% capture, +\$230. Trade 169 was thin premium again — \$0.45 entry stopped on gamma. Never threatened. -\$180.

FRIDAY 15 MAY — +\$720 (Best Day)

SPX fell 1.24% on profit-taking. Intel -6%, AMD -5.7%, Nvidia -4.4%. Trade 170: BPS with \$0.80 premium (above floor), 62.5% capture, +\$500. Clean. Trade 171: Second live iron condor! Wide OTM, 55% capture, closed early for ballet. +\$220. Both trades demonstrate the system at its best — sufficient premium, clear conditions, disciplined exit.

ERROR & RULE BREACH LOG

#	Type	P&L	Detail	Rule Violated
162	Indecision/Churning	\$0	4 transactions, \$91 fees, zero P&L. Low conviction	No signal = no-trade
164	Emotional Reopen	-\$225	Reopened same position after stop-out driven by frustration	Re-trade (same-market gate)
166	Unplanned Entry	-\$750	Uncancelled pre-market order filled into PPI print. Stop cancelled	Stop cancelled pre-market orders

Error cost: -\$975 plus \$91 in wasted fees. Trade 166 is the most concerning — it's the same error pattern as the USO trade from Account 1 (uncancelled pre-market order leading to unplanned entry). The cascade from there (cancelled stop, panic close) is familiar too. On live money, this pattern is unacceptable. Pre-market orders must be verified cancelled before the open. Every time. No exceptions.

Trade 164's emotional reopen is a known vulnerability. The positive signal: you recognised it and closed quickly (-\$225 instead of potentially much worse). The self-correction is faster than it was in Accounts 1-2. But the impulse itself hasn't been eliminated — only the recovery time.

SHADOW ACCOUNT (+\$8,440)

#	Type	Strikes	Cts	Entry	Exit	P&L	Notes
S8	BPS	7385/7365	50	\$0.50	\$0.00	+\$2,500	Expired. 50-lot comparison.
S9	IC	7400-7375	10	\$5.00	\$4.15	+\$850	First IC! 17% capture.
S10	IC	7405-7370	10	\$2.25	\$0.00	+\$2,250	Expired. Full premium.
S11	BPS	7370/7350	10	\$0.65	\$0.05	+\$600	92% capture. Comparison.
S12	IC	7450-7425	1	\$6.75	\$0.00	+\$675	IC 1-lot. Sized down. Expired.
S13	IC	7510-7475	1	\$6.70	\$0.00	+\$670	IC 1-lot. 3rd consecutive.
S14	IC	7440-7405	1	\$8.95	\$0.00	+\$895	IC 1-lot. 4th. Highest premium.

Iron Condor Development:

Five IC trades this week, all winners. Started at 10-lot (S9, S10), sized down to 1-lot (S12-S14) for systematic testing. Four of five expired worthless. Premium ranged from \$2.25 to \$8.95. The IC structure on SPX 0DTE is showing genuine promise — wide OTM wings with \$6-9 premium at 1-lot gives excellent risk/reward. The live IC (#171, +\$220) confirmed the structure works on real money. This is ready for gradual scaling on the live account.

MARKET CONTEXT

An extraordinary week for macro data. CPI came in hot at 3.8% YoY on Tuesday (above 3.6% expected), driven by energy costs from the Iran blockade bleeding into shelter and services. PPI was scorching on Wednesday at 6.0% YoY (above 4.8% expected) with the largest monthly gain since March 2022. Rate hike odds climbed to 39% for December. Despite this, SPX hit all-time highs of 7,514 on Thursday as the Trump-Xi summit in China produced agreement that the Strait of Hormuz should remain a free waterway. Kevin Warsh was confirmed as the new Fed Chair. Friday brought a 1.24% correction as profits were taken in tech. VIX ranged 17-19 across the week.

LESSONS LEARNED

WHAT WORKED

- ✓ Thick premium trades: 83% win rate, +\$1,575. The system works above the premium floor.
- ✓ Trade 168 tranche entry: Averaging into better premium on dips. New technique, clean execution.
- ✓ Trade 170 correction day: Adapted to falling market, placed strikes 100+ points below, 62.5% capture.
- ✓ Iron condors: Live #171 profitable. Shadow 5/5 wins. Structure validated across both accounts.

- ✓ Self-correction speed: Trade 164's emotional reopen was caught and closed quickly. Getting faster at recognising mistakes.
- ✓ Sizing discipline on live: 4-15 contracts. Conservative while learning live execution. Correct approach.

WHAT NEEDS IMPROVEMENT

- **1. Minimum Credit Floor:** No SPX 0DTE credit spread below \$0.60 premium. This is a hard gate for the pre-trade checklist. Below \$0.60 = no trade.
- **2. Pre-Market Order Hygiene:** Trade 166 repeated the USO error from Account 1. On live money this is not acceptable. Verify all pre-market orders cancelled before the open. Add to morning routine as a mandatory step.
- **3. Emotional Reopen Gate:** Trade 164 was recognised and corrected quickly, but the impulse persists. The 30-minute cooling-off rule after any stop-out should be enforced.
- **4. Churning Cost:** Trade 162 generated \$91 in real fees for zero P&L.; Indecision on live money has a direct cost. If conviction isn't there, don't enter.

CONCLUSION

The Premium Floor Is the Week's Discovery. Live account -\$380 on the headline, but the underlying data tells a precise story: thick premium trades made +\$1,575, thin premium trades lost -\$1,205, and one error cost -\$750. The system isn't broken — it's being applied below the minimum viable premium level. Fix the floor and the live account is immediately profitable.

Iron Condors Are Ready. Five shadow wins and one live win. The structure works on SPX 0DTE with wide OTM wings. Premium of \$6-9 at 1-lot gives excellent R:R. Gradual scaling on the live account should begin next week.

The Emotional Pattern Is Shrinking. Trade 164's reopen was caught in minutes, not hours. Trade 166's cascade was worse — cancelled stop, panic close — but the root cause was operational (uncancelled order), not emotional. The self-correction is measurably faster than Accounts 1-2. The framework is becoming instinct. Not there yet, but trending.

Next Report: Friday, May 22, 2026